W-S-001361
March 25, 1968

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SAFETY DEVICE, FLUORESCENT LAMP

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, D. C. 20405, based on currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers safety devices to be used in fluorescent lamp fixtures, to prevent lamp(s) from shaking loose and falling.

1.2 Classification. Safety devices shall be of the following classes and types, as specified (see 6.1):

Classes:
- Class I - For use with 40-watt T-12 rapid-start fluorescent lamp (USAS C78,700).
- Class II - For use with 96-inch (800-milliampere) T-12 rapid-start fluorescent lamp (USAS C78.702).
- Class III - For use with 96-inch (1.5-ampere) T-12 and PG-17 rapid-start fluorescent lamp (USAS C78.707).

Types:
- Type I - For use with open-end fixtures.
- Type II - For use with closed-end fixtures.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:
- PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
- PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-plywood.
- PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
- PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
- PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standard:
- Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:
- MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

~~FSC 6210~~

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military Standards:
MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

United States of America Standards Institute Standards (USAS):
C78.700 - 40-Watt T-12 Rapid-Start Fluorescent Lamp.
C78.702 - 96-Inch (800-Milliampere) T-12 Rapid-Start Fluorescent Lamp.
C78.707 - 96-Inch (1.5-Ampere) T-12 and PG-17 Rapid-Start Fluorescent Lamp.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the United States of America Standards Institute, 10 East 40th Street, New York, N. Y. 10016.)

Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., Standards (UL):
UL 120 I30 - Listing - Fixture Fittings.

(Application for copies should be addressed to Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., Walt Whitman Road, Melville, New York 11749; 207 East Ohio Street, Chicago, Illinois 60611; or 1655 Scott Boulevard, Santa Clara, California 95050.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Fire and casualty hazards.

3.1.1 Each contractor shall submit to the contracting agency proof that the safety device he proposes to supply under this specification conforms to the applicable requirements of the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., UL listing number 120 I30, Fixture Fittings. The label, or listing with re-examination, of the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., may be accepted as evidence that the safety device conforms to this requirement.

3.1.2 In lieu of the label, or listing with re-examination, the contractor may submit independent proof, satisfactory to the contracting agency, that the lighting fixture conforms to the applicable requirements of the published standards including methods of tests of the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc.

3.1.3 Compliance with the above preliminary requirements in regard to fire and casualty hazards does not absolve the contractor from compliance with the other requirements of this specification in order to secure acceptance of his material or appliance.

3.2 Safety devices furnished under this specification shall be of the class and type specified in the procurement document and shall be suitable for use with the lamps specified in the applicable USA Standard (see 1.2).

3.2.1 The safety device shall accommodate lampholders of either the depressible contact bi-pin or the recessed double contact type.

3.3 Installation and replacement.

3.3.1 The number of safety devices necessary to insure that each lamp remains secure in the fixture shall not require more than two minutes to install.

3.3.2 With safety device(s) installed and lamp in operative position, it shall not take more than 30 seconds to remove that lamp, replace it with another lamp, and return the safety device(s) to functioning position.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.3 Safety devices shall be fully assembled and ready for installation. The lamp shall be removable without the use of special tools.

3.4 Workmanship. All devices furnished under the specification shall be first-grade commercial products and shall be free from mechanical defects.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Materials and components. The supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications and standards to the extent specified, or, if note, in accordance with this specification. In the event of conflict, this specification shall govern.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection sampling. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.2.1 Lot. For the purpose of sampling the safety device, a lot shall consist of all the safety devices offered for delivery at one time.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. The examination of the safety device shall be made in accordance with the classification of defects, inspection levels, and acceptance levels (AQL's) set forth below.

4.3.1 Inspection for minor physical defects. Minor physical defects are those which mar the appearance of the devices or are otherwise incompatible with good workmanship or good service. For determining sample size, the inspection level shall be 1 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.3.2 Inspection for major physical defects. Major physical defects are those which render devices inoperative or which would cause them unquestionably to give poor service. For determining sample size, the inspection level shall be 1 and the AQL shall be 1.5 defects per hundred units.

4.3.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in an end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or methods of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, or loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of containers.

4.4 Performance test. The safety device shall be tested to assure compliance with the requirements of 3.2 and 3.3.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Each pair of safety devices shall be enclosed in a heat sealed polyethylene bag. Ten pairs of safety devices shall be packaged in a snug-fitted box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, PPP-B-676, or PPP-B-636, class domestic.

5.1.2 Level B. Each pair of safety devices shall be enclosed in kraft paper, cloth or plastic bag. Ten pairs of devices shall be packaged in a snug-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, PPP-B-676, or PPP-B-636, class domestic.

5.1.3 Level C. Each pair of safety devices shall be enclosed in a suitable bag. The safety devices shall then be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.1.4 Intermediate packaging, levels A and B. Five packages (100 devices shall be intermediate packaged in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. The safety devices in quantities as specified (see 6.1), shall be packed in a snug-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type. The wood cleated plywood box shall be provided with a case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547, or a 3 mil polyethylene liner, and sealed. The boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the specification appendix.

5.2.2 Level B. Fifty intermediate packages (5000 devices) intermediate packaged as specified in 5.1.4 shall be packed in a snug-fitted fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Boxes shall be closed in accordance with the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The safety devices shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packaging and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packaging and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Class and type desired (see 1.2).
(c) Responsibility for inspection, if other than specified (see 4.1).
(d) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) Markings, if other than specified (see 5.3).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.